

Enterprise Architecture Preliminary Phase Proposal

Mentoring Unit, Center for Student Affairs (CSA)

University of Asia and the Pacific

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IT Elective: Solution Architecture

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SECTION 1: ENTERPRISE BOUNDARY AND PROBLEM AUTHENTICITY

1.1 Enterprise Scope and Landscape Baseline

The CSA mentoring unit is composed of only two employees who share the same work. They report to the CSA Executive Director. Although they are only two, the unit's operations interface with the different schools, the IST Department, Finance, HR, the Registrar, and ManCom

The unit is responsible for storing the mentor-student pairings and the mentoring session logs. These are stored via two separate Google Sheets. Students are the ones responsible for recording their mentoring sessions via a Google Form that connects to the mentoring session logs Sheet, provided by the unit. This form has an email script that informs the mentors to confirm the session details. Another script then sends an email confirming the confirmation to a dedicated admin email. It should be noted that the IST department is responsible for the creation and management of these two specific tools.

1.2 Business Catalyst

The Mentoring Unit is responsible for the facilitation of the Mentoring Program in compliance with the University's initiative for Student Holistic Development. In line with this, the university implemented a policy that requires each school to provide mentors for students. A new policy has also been implemented as of AY 2026-27 that now requires students to have at least three mentoring sessions per semester. Failure to meet this requirement in three consecutive semesters will result in issues in the students' enrollment for the following semester.

These policies triggered this architecture effort to improve the unit's processes in two primary areas. The first is ensuring data integrity in the storage of student-mentor pairings and the recording of mentoring session logs. The second is an earlier submission of approved mentor-student pairings before the start of a semester.

1.3 Primary Operational Failure Modes

The lack of secure data integrity. The two Google Sheets are isolated from one another and require the unit to update both of them if one of them is updated (e.g., a student changes their mentor). Additionally, the admin email can accumulate many emails, making it difficult to confirm if the mentor has indeed confirmed the session details the students have submitted.

Another operational failure is the time it takes for mentor-student pairings to be created. The entire process is dependent on the Registrar to submit an approved list of enrolled students and the different school coordinators to submit their pairings to the unit. These are often subject to delays due to the new students suddenly enrolling or the coordinators submitting the pairings list late, causing the unit to update the sheets frequently and delaying the mentor-student pairings email to students. Ideally, this is supposed to be accomplished before the start of the semester, which is not met semi-annually.

SECTION 2: DELIVERABLE 1 - ORGANIZATIONAL MODEL FOR EA

2.1 Scope of Organizations Impacted and Governance Structure

The engagement will mainly impact the specific processes under the mentoring unit. All other interfaces cannot be touched, such as the schools, registrar, HR, and finance, as they each have their own processes. However, the IST department and ManCom must at least be informed of any new changes in policies or procedures, followed by the relevant people who are part of the mentoring program.

2.2 Stakeholder Power Alignment and RACI Matrix

The top three stakeholders are the Mentoring Unit, the CSA Executive Director, and the IST Office. The Mentoring Unit will be the one accountable and responsible for approving and implementing any process changes or policies. The Executive Director will be accountable for the approval of these processes. Lastly, the IST Office will be responsible for the implementation and management of any new tools and accountable for securing data integrity.

2.3 Framework Interface Assessment

The project interfaces with the CSA Approval Governance chain. This is an existing framework and cannot be modified. All changes need to be approved by the unit, Executive Director, and ManCom, and approval times can vary. The second interface is the operating rhythm of the unit. The majority of the operations, specifically the submission of approved mentors, mentor-student pairings, and session logs, are constrained by the academic calendar. The last interface to consider is that the unit has no formal work methodology. All work is adhoc.

SECTION 3: DELIVERABLE 2 - TAILORED ARCHITECTURE FRAMEWORK

3.1 Metamodel Tailoring Logic

Taken from the TOGAF's 36 Core Metamodel entities (2022, Figure 3-8), 29 were retained, and 7 were removed, with no new entity types added. Removal of entities was made on the basis that they are absent from operations (Product, Location), outside unit governance (Course of Action, Logical/Physical Technology Components), or redundant (Function, Service Quality). In place of custom entity extensions, the team mapped domain-specific instances to retained entities: Student, Mentor, School, Pairing, Session Log, Mentor Confirmation, Approved Mentor List, Enrollment Record, and External Mentor Contract. Dual retentions were justified by operational realities: Business Information/Data Entity addresses data mirrored across disconnected spreadsheets, Actor/Role captures dual-role faculty, and Technology Service models Google Workspace SaaS usage without infrastructure ownership.

3.2 Committed Architecture Deliverables

The team commits to producing 11 specific artifacts across ADM phases A through E. The team will be utilizing both ArchiMate for most diagrams and BPMN for business process diagrams.

Phase A delivers the Architecture Vision Diagram; **Phase B** covers the Business Capability Map, Capability, Process, and Organization Unit Matrix, and Business Process Diagrams (Pairing and Change of Mentor); **Phase C** produces the Data Entity Diagram and Data Entity to Organization Unit Matrix for Data, alongside the Application Portfolio Catalog, Application Communication Diagram, and Application to Data Entity Matrix for Applications; **Phase D** provides the Technology Service Catalog; and **Phase E** concludes with the Architecture Roadmap incorporating Gap Analysis.

SECTION 4: DELIVERABLE 3 - COLLABORATIVE FOUNDATIONS AND EVIDENCE

4.1 Principles Catalog

The architecture establishes three core principles that enforce strict operational trade-offs using the TOGAF framework: Student-Owned Session Records mandates that students log their own meetings while the unit only validates them, trading off administrative data entry for student accountability to handle high volume; Google Workspace as Primary Operations Tool dictates that all solutions must leverage existing licensed tools (Forms, Sheets, Apps Script) before acquiring new software, a trade-off that prioritizes long-term maintainability over custom features following the abandonment of an earlier dedicated portal; and Data Consistency and Accuracy requires pairing rosters and form logs to be automatically reconciled, trading isolated local spreadsheet autonomy for trusted university-wide compliance reporting.

4.2 Primary Data Sources & Baseline Metrics

The proposal reflects a real-world enterprise engagement grounded in a requirements interview conducted on September 11, 2026, with CSA Mentoring Unit Operations Coordinators Ms. Nina and Ms. Kellai, sponsored by CSA Executive Director Ms. Maria Concha De La Cruz in response to the university policy announced on August 7, 2026. The concrete operational scale is verified by strict baseline figures: a lean staff of only two (2) coordinators must oversee and validate records for 1,500 to 1,600 undergraduate students and approximately 180 faculty mentors to meet a mandatory quota of three (3) sessions per semester, with future process rollouts constrained to a pilot group of roughly 100 students in the School of Social Sciences and Education (SSE).